

Pulling Your Miracle From Heaven

Answered Prayer on the Soul Level Begins with the Will of God

Put a marker in Romans 10; we will be there in a moment. We left off basically at Ephesians 5:17.

We are talking about answered prayer on the soul level, or the level of the intellect. We preach so much about praying in tongues that when we address this kind of prayer, we do so as the prayer of faith, praying with your understanding, learning how to meet a problem gut-level, receive faith to see it change, and be transformed to His Word.

Ephesians 5:17 says:

Wherefore be ye not unwise, but understanding what the will of the Lord is.

What we have come to find out is that when we are believing for something, we must first not be unwise concerning the will of the Lord.

The last example I left you with was this: what if I were a covenant man, a faith man, an absolute faith man, who adhered to our covenant and believed He provided healing for every believer, salvation for every person who attained to it, and prosperity for every believer?

As faith people, we are quick to say, "It is in our covenant. It is our covenant. He has provided healing, prosperity, peace, and all these things for us." As a faith person, I know healing is mine. So if the devil puts something on me, I do not have to question whether healing is mine. I know that from my doctrine and from my faith.

So He said, "Be not unwise concerning what the will of the Lord is."

Then He said:

And be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess; but be filled with the Spirit;

And He told you how to be filled with the Spirit:

Speaking to yourselves in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs, singing and making melody in your heart to the Lord.

Covenant Knowledge Is Level One, but the Rewarder Is Level Two

I left you with an example, and I made it as drastic as I could. I may stand here as your teacher and have thirty deaf, dumb, mute, and blind children behind me, all under five years old.

According to our doctrine, we know Jesus has provided healing for every one of them, do we not?

We know that because I take great pride in standing up and teaching to the nth degree about our covenant of healing.

So we know He has provided healing for all those children.

The first level of faith is this: he who comes to God must believe that He is. I must come to Him believing that He is what He said He is in our covenant. If He has provided healing for those thirty children, and I am teaching you that He has provided healing for them, then we are all coming to God believing that He is, that He is what He said He is, and that He has provided healing for them.

But where we are finding a breakdown as faith people is that we never go to the second level:

...and that he is a rewarder of them that diligently seek him.

Even though we adhere to and teach in minute detail that we have a covenant, it seems like none of us faith teachers ever come to the level where we bother to find out, pay the price, and go into God enough to discover why, if He has a covenant for these children, they are growing up in our church that way.

Maybe one out of a thousand, like Betty Baxter or May Stafford, receives that kind of miracle. May Stafford finished in a wheelchair, blind, and about forty-five years old, looking almost a hundred. She leaped out of the wheelchair and was gone, preaching ever since. Betty Baxter was twisted in a wheelchair at thirteen or fourteen years old, barely two or three feet tall, her mouth over on the side of her face, deformed from birth and never knowing anything else. One day Jesus came after her mother had prayed from the day she was born for thirteen years, standing on the Word that she was healed. Jesus came in the room, touched her, and her mouth snapped around front. Some sixty-five years ago she has been preaching ever since, on high-speed go, absolutely put together by Jesus.

Maybe one out of a thousand will receive a miracle like that. Yet we faith people stand up and say we have a covenant, but we do not seem to love God enough to go in and find out why these people, and we who have a covenant, grow up that way.

If we have a covenant, where are we missing it in our teaching? We cannot seem to supply enough information for these people to attain. Maybe the parents do not love God enough to go on in and receive it for their child.

Should we not understand our covenant enough to come before Him and say, "I believe He is who He said He is in our covenant"? But we do not seem to know Him enough, love Him enough, or have enough faith to believe He is also a rewarder for every one of those children. Every one of them.

He is a rewarder of those who diligently seek Him.

A man who takes the time to find out how to go unto God and pull out a miracle for those thirty children will certainly have to believe, when he approaches Him, that He is a rewarder. You will not get to first base if you do not believe He is a rewarder. What is going to motivate you to go in? You will have to believe with every thread in your being that He is a rewarder of those who diligently seek Him, or somewhere along the line, especially if they are not your children, you will give up.

The world is too easy to embrace. It is too fun to play with. Most of us leave as much as possible in the world and still get to heaven. We leave as much as we can in the world and still feel that we are filling some kind of role in God, bringing people to church or something and sitting there looking real happy.

Coming to God believing He is means understanding we have this covenant with Him. Believing that He is a rewarder of those who diligently seek Him means taking it past the flesh, which can offer so many pleasurable realms to stop a person.

We know we have a covenant. We know healing is for that child. But I just never bothered to attain to enough agape. "Who cares about that child? I am doing okay. It is not my problem." So we never attain to enough agape or love to go on into the place where He is the rewarder of those who diligently seek Him.

A Long-Term Problem Can Program the Senses Against Hope

I used as an example a child with a severe lifelong condition. I do not have this child; I am speaking hypothetically. Say I did, and for twenty-five years every moment my senses had been programmed by that problem. He is a man, twenty-five years old, but he runs off with ten-year-olds to play. It is interesting when his body wakes up to manhood, but his mind still wants to play with children. You have to watch him every moment.

My senses have been exasperated. They have been worn out. This sensual domination is before me every moment for twenty-five years.

Then suppose five years ago I stumbled into the faith message. I take my child to every camp meeting for five or six years and set him there in hope, hoping God will come out of heaven. But the ministers have been programmed by the same sensual domination, the same devil. They have had hundreds of thousands in their meetings and have never really seen those kinds of people receive much. Most of the time, when they approach your child to pray, they have not gone over there either.

Even though God uses them in miracles, He uses you in a miracle realm with a ceiling on it. He uses you up to a certain level and certain kinds of miracles, and you seem never to operate above that.

I have a gift that operates in my ministry. It operates under a ceiling. People get healed all over the crowd. Eyes are healed. Teeth get filled with silver and gold at times. Sometimes in a crowd of two hundred, thirty people will stand up and receive an instant manifestation. But the miracles are always under the ceiling of a certain strength. Occasionally somebody will jump up with something phenomenal and get put back together, but that has more to do with the combination of their faith and mine, and the strength of that anointing working with their faith. An unusual combination comes together outside of my faith, outside of my operation, and the combination pulls a miracle. Then we get to brag about it for six months.

The same thing happens with the man operating in a realm above mine. He may see fourteen or fifteen wheelchairs out of two hundred get up. But you do not see very many children with profound birth defects, missing arms and legs, little shells sitting there with their heads on them, born that way and looking at you, watching people get up and walk, hoping this will be the time.

Occasionally, in the best ministries men have, one of those kinds of miracles pops out. It is like filming a flower that buds, then speeding the camera up so you can watch it unfold. That is what happens. It is nothing to God. We have made it something to Him because it is such a sense-dominated realm that He very seldom gets to come among human beings and operate there.

If we cannot see it, we have a lot more faith for it if it is hidden inside the body somewhere. If they look normal but cannot walk, it is easier, because the sensual domination is not so strong.

Creative Miracles Are Not Hard for God, but They Confront the Sense Realm

You have to understand that time is relative. God can operate at the speed of light, or He can operate at a human being's speed. Time to Him is relative to whom He is dealing with. He can send an angel from heaven, and the angel can be here at the speed of thought. Time is relative to what He is operating in.

When you watch a plant grow, God set the standard for the plant. But when He watches you move, you move in a realm uncommon to that plant. That plant cannot even see you move. You move so fast, you are a blur. That is the way we are to angels; they move in a realm we cannot see.

All time is a creation of God, so it is all relative. Even though something grows slowly, we can film it and speed it up. If you take a crab or something that replenishes its own arms because its DNA is programmed to do that, you can watch that arm grow out. Put a camera on it and speed it up, and you can watch it.

Do you want to know how God would do a creative miracle? He would activate the DNA and speed it up. All of a sudden that arm would grow out. It would be nothing to Him. He would trigger it, and it would grow at a rate where you could watch it grow. A hundred thousand people would watch two arms and two legs appear.

To Him, it would be nothing. To us, it is such a sense-dominated realm that we cannot even adhere to it. We cannot even begin to focus on it. The devil is here to make sure you never will. He will beat you in the sense realm and make sure you never will.

Because if you get two or three miracles like that on a consistent basis, you will offer hundreds of thousands of sinners absolutely infallible proof, an invasion in the sense realm that there is a God who is. As in history, every time before, that has springboarded into world-shaking revivals.

Do you know what Jesus meant when He said if the miracles done in those towns had been done in Sodom and Gomorrah, they would have repented in sackcloth and ashes? He was saying that if there had been a sensual invasion into miracles in that city as there had been in these cities, they would have repented. They did not have a religious system to stop them. But the religious system stopped the people Jesus ministered to from repenting. When Jesus raised the dead right in their midst, the system stepped in and said, "No, it is not the God of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob; it is the devil."

He did miracles right in their midst, and they did not repent. He said Sodom and Gomorrah would have. That is what an invasion into the sense realm does.

The Prayer Closet Reprograms Violated Senses with the Covenant

So for five years I have been dragging this hypothetical child around, listening to the elite of the faith teachers. Finally, I am reduced to realizing I am not going to get help from the miracle realm God operates in through the church. If my child is going to receive this kind of miracle, I guess I am going to have to go into God and get it.

For twenty-five years, my senses have been dominated by buttoning his shirt, running him down, keeping him away from children he wants to play with, trying to keep him with me when he runs off into crowds and operates in a sense realm not common to a twenty-five-year-old. My senses, every minute of the day for twenty-five years, have been programmed. They have been robbed of hope until there is nothing for faith to put substance to.

If you will allow me, my senses have been violated by twenty-five years of sensual domination, the problem slamming me and beating me in the face. You can count on half a hand in history the people who have received something like that from God, because they too have repeated history and been beaten by the sensual realm.

It is like looking at a child with no arms or legs, then looking at God and knowing He is God, but being beaten to death by what you see. Then when I abandon my child to the system of faith, to the churches and the realms of miracles they walk in, I find myself five years later with my hope reduced even further to desperation. I have tasted the best they have to offer, and I have been violated.

Is there any hope?

This is what Ephesians 5 is talking about.

First, I am not unwise to the will of God. I have come to Him and decided He is the healer. He is the healer of my child. He is. Now I am taking my faith to level two: He is a rewarder to Dave Roberson, who is diligently seeking Him.

What are you seeking Him for, boy? I am going to turn my senses from a state of violation to a state where they are so under subjection to the Word that I need no outside evidence but His Word. My emotions, which were so violated night after night that I was robbed of sleep, are going to need no outside stimulation but the Word of God to know that He is the rewarder of those who diligently seek Him.

I am not unwise as to the will of God. I have come to Him accepting what they have taught me and what I have learned: in my covenant, even if these preachers do not go there, my God has given my child the same body.

The next verse is startling:

And be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess; but be filled with the Spirit;

He tells you how to be filled: by ministering to your own selves, your own heart, your own soul, your mind, will, intellect, and emotions.

That is how I am filled with the Spirit: by ministering to my own soul in psalms, hymns, and spiritual songs, giving thanks always for all things contained within the will of God for my child, whom I am not unwise about. I know what He said, so I know where to go in the Psalms. I know the songs I need to sing. I know what spiritual songs I need to adhere to. I know what singing I need to write and minister, as far as the Word of God is concerned, to my own soul.

That is how I fill myself with the Spirit.

Being Filled with the Spirit Makes the Word More Real Than the Problem

Notice something here. He said, "Be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess." Why did He say that?

Twenty-five years of my senses being violated every moment, looking at the problem. What does a man in the world do? What does an alcoholic do? Why is he an alcoholic? Because life to him became that kind of problem, so he escaped it in a bottle and did not have to face the reality of the problem anymore.

He says, "Do not be drunk like that. Be filled with the Spirit by ministering to your own soul until you have taken your senses and emotions and brought them so under subjection to the Word of God that says your child is healed that you become drunk to the circumstances that say your child is not healed."

You become so intoxicated on the mind, will, and Word of God that says, "My child is healed," that you are filled with the Spirit and pull your senses under subjection to the Word until, like the drunk man, you are able to live next to the problem believing God has done it, until He comes into the room and gives your child's body back.

You can change anything. You can change anything.

Listen to me very closely. In level-one faith, which most faith people walk in, we love the Word. We admire it. We believe we have this covenant, so we put our child in the line. They pray, then say, "Just confess the Word."

But your emotions have been violated twenty-four hours a day for twenty-five years. What makes you think you are going to pull your senses out from under subjection to that and become so filled with the Spirit, so drunk on what the Word says that the problem no longer bothers you, by making the journey on the common level that faith people walk in?

Your problem is not common. You get them in the prayer line, and they say, "Do you believe your child is healed?"

"Yes, I do. I believe I receive. When He prayed for him, with His stripes he is healed."

Then you go off and live with the problem. You hear a general message on Sunday and a general message on Monday. We are trying to cover all the needs of a human being, spirit, soul, and body: marriage, relationships, what comes first, what comes second, and the emotional trauma of somebody taking your poor Lexus away from you. We had an emergency the other day: we had to lay our pool man off. Or, "I had a divorce. My husband beat me up and left. My wife beat me up and left."

We have all these problems common to human beings. Of course, we cannot go past twelve, because you have a problem to run to. We cannot expect you to turn out to prayer.

There was a super church near Dallas, Texas, in a neighboring town, that majored on prayer, one of the finest in the nation. They taught people how to pray early in the morning. When the pastor came out and led prayer out of a church of nine thousand people, a couple hundred would come out. Then they had ministers of prayer carry it on Monday, Tuesday, and Wednesday.

Out of nine thousand people, I asked the minister of prayer, "How many came?"

"Twenty-six."

We have some cancer loose.

We do not want to bother you too much. We do not want to take you too many minutes past twelve. You have a problem to run to. Thank God for His grace. We can smile at those children and thank God we are good-looking and have bodies that work just fine. "Do not bother me with these people's problems. I have problems of my own."

We are trying to nurture you in the general sense, minister to your marriage and relationships and what comes first, second, and third. But you are trying to hang on to enough Word to win over twenty-five years of sensual domination and violation of your senses. You run around on a message you heard two months ago, and somebody asks, "Is your child healed?"

"Oh yes."

Do you think you are going to turn twenty-four hours a day of sense domination, over twenty-five years, by opening your mouth and occasionally saying something about the problem?

When you are facing a problem to that level, and it is rare, your problem is not common. Most of you are just trying to decide whether you want a reward or not, whether you want to warm a chair the rest of your life or not. Your problems are not that great.

The Greatest Servant Serves More of the Supper Jesus Prepared

This is why Jesus said he who is greatest among you should be your servant. A servant is somebody who goes into God until he can serve off that dinner God prepared for the world through Jesus Christ. The greater the servant you are, the more courses of that meal you can serve.

He said, "I have prepared a great supper, so you ministries go call the lame, the halt, the maimed, the sick, and the blind, and compel them to come, for the supper is now ready."

The supper He is talking about is what God prepared through Jesus Christ for the world. The people who went out to compel the blind, the halt, and the maimed to come in are you. You now want to serve this dinner to them. A servant.

The more you go beyond your needs and your flesh to serve other human beings, the more of a servant of God you are.

Most of you are not facing problems like that. I grant you some of you are. Most of you are just trying to decide whether you want a reward, whether you will fulfill your call, whether you want to please God.

But some people find themselves in this situation, and it is not by their choice. The disciples asked, "Is it this man's fault that he was born this way? Was it his parents' fault?" Jesus said, "No." He had the misfortune of being born to a fallen race of people. Jesus said, "I have come to work the works of Him that sent Me. I must work the works of Him that sent Me while it is day, for the night is coming when no man can work." Then He showed the works of Him who sent Him and healed that man who had been born that way.

So now you may not have that misfortune. They did not have a welfare system. A family might say, "Son, you understand you are eighteen now and we are having a hard time with the crops. Swallow your manhood, go down on the corner, and start begging for us."

Then Jesus came by.

You think it is hard on you? You think a little child without arms, if his spirit is not as free as your little children who run around picking toys up at the speed of thought, does not watch them run?

We get so caught up in our problems. I am not trying to condemn you. But your freedom costs a price. He has provided everything, but we have let the devil deceive us. We have become content meeting people's needs up to a certain level, and that is called a social church. You demand too much of people, and they leave you.

I appreciate you. Jesus can only operate on the level that we let Him, whether good, acceptable, or perfect. He is trying to break loose. He is looking for people desperately, if He could be desperate. He could not live with Himself if He had not taken the hurt and the deformity, knowing He provided for those children. He knew He would when He came into His human body.

That is why Isaiah 52:14 says many were astonished at His visible appearance. He was marred more than any man, and His form more than the sons of men. Then Isaiah 53 took place in Him. My form is what makes me a man. You look at me and see the form of a man. But it says His form was altered more than the sons of men, which means every generation born to human beings. There was none whose form was more altered than Jesus when He cried, "My God, why have You forsaken Me?" and the Holy Spirit withdrew and left Him abandoned at the mercy of him who has none.

His form was altered more than any human being who has ever passed through this earth, to ensure that any human being who came along, no matter the deformity, could find that in His altered form He had borne it. It is a matter of faith.

The Gospel of Peace Brings Glad Tidings of Good Things

If twenty-four hours a day the sense man is violated until hope is gone, whether by a child with a severe condition or no arms or no legs, then you are being asked to see something you cannot see and believe something that does not exist in front of you. You are going to have to give hours, untold hours, of your sense man to a vision you cannot see.

Hours and hours of deprogramming. Hours and hours walking the floor, ministering to your own soul in spiritual songs and hymns, making melody, sometimes taking fourteen-hour stretches over and over, gracing your soul with statements:

"You have exalted Your Word above Your name. You are not a man that You should lie. I worship You and glorify You. I say that my child is normal. You hear me? I am calling him normal."

For the next three hours, I hear myself saying, "He is normal. He is normal. In Jesus' name, he is normal." Then I lapse into the Spirit and for fourteen hours worship Him, exalt His Word, and thank Him for the covenant.

Why? If it took twenty-five years of violation of my senses, it may take a while.

Who loves that much? Most do not come because they cannot even believe He is. They are afraid. "If I do that for five years and He does not come, my life will be spent."

He who comes to God must believe that He is. What is this? Do you just jump up and spout that covenant out because it sounds good? Are you trusting Him to take you across the barrier of death into heaven for the next fifty multi-millennial billions of earth years? You are trusting that lifespan with Him whom you have not seen, and you cannot take something like this on?

What did He say? I do not have to run to a bottle like an alcoholic to escape that kind of violation. I have found out how to be filled with the Spirit. I have found out how to minister to my own soul until the Holy Spirit rises from my inner man, infiltrates my soul, intoxicates my senses with the reality of God until I see what He says, until I am crazy as far as the world is concerned because I can see a miracle they cannot. Eventually, they are going to see it too.

Incredible, is it not? It may take me a while. It took Betty Baxter's mother, and then she taught Betty Baxter when she was old enough, thirteen or fourteen years.

"So you really believe Jesus is going to come and heal your daughter?"

"No, I do not really believe it. I know He is."

"Oh, come on."

"No, I know."

Have you ever heard Betty Baxter's testimony? Her dad? Maybe all the preachers? No, only her mother. Only her mother, and later Betty hung on. It must have been a sight to see that mouth snap around front, to see her palate form until she could speak normally, to see perfect speech come in the time it takes somebody to stand up.

Well, it was sovereign. Yes, it was. He sovereignly passed through and pulled her disease under subjection to a one-time event when He finished the work in positional truth and said, "It is done," and gave it to you. Now find out how to bring yourself under subjection to it. Quit asking Him to provide it again, and find out how to believe what He has already done.

He has the most incredible miracles waiting for you.

Romans 10 says:

How beautiful are the feet of them that preach the gospel of peace, and bring glad tidings of good things!

The "good things" are plural. The gospel of peace, glad tidings of good things. What is it? Captive, you do not have to be captive anymore. Blind, you do not have to be blind anymore. Sick, you do not have to be sick anymore. Poor, you do not have to be poor anymore.

That is the gospel of peace, glad tidings of good things.

As preachers with beautiful feet, whenever we run into children and people like that, they have as much of a calling and as much of a reward waiting to be fulfilled in heaven as you do. We are supposed to deliver the whole gospel of glad tidings. We are supposed to dispense good news to them and set them on the same path you are on, so they have as much chance for a reward as you have.

Think how your reward compounds. You fill a good ministry and get a few people saved, and God is real happy about it. But say you invaded the sense realm like that and had hundreds of thousands of people restored. Then they go answer their call and get hundreds of thousands born again, and they are all on your account.

Every person Betty Baxter has gotten born again is on her mama's account. Yes, sir. Because her mama would not fall short one iota of this gospel of glad tidings, this good news of good things.

Do you think Jesus would teach like that if He were standing here? There is quite a bit of difference between me and Him. He could back it up a lot better than I could. But that is what we are working on.

First the revelation comes. Yes, sir. Then the transformation, then the glory. We are in the transformation process. I am somewhere between the first level and the second, but at least I am going.

I think we need to worship God a little bit.